

## E-mail #2: "Converting a Suspect to a Prospect"

Last week, I sent you an introduction email in which I suggested that you create a "Suspect" list. I hope you have had time to develop a list of 20 or 30 names. Now it is time to convert the Suspects into Prospects. Here are the steps:

**Step 1:** Check to make sure that the Suspect is not already a Souvenir Program advertiser. This can be done by checking the name against the index in last year's Souvenir Program and by checking it against the "Protected" List.

You can pick up a hard copy of the list and last year's Souvenir Program at the Rookie Orientation session and at the next General Committee.

If your suspect is already on the list, then they cannot become a prospect. So just cross them off the list.

**Step 2:** You should still have 20 to 25 suspects after completing step 1. The next step is to gather data to begin to qualify your prospect. You should get the following data about the suspect:

- Name
- Title
- Name of Company
- Address of Company
- Phone Number
- Fax Number
- Web site
- Nature of Business

You might want to visit the company web site to understand the nature of the business, how long it has been in existence, etc. **A qualified prospect is a decision maker** in a company that has been around long enough to have a web site and become successful. I find it helpful to develop a 3X5 card (either a hard copy or a spreadsheet version) with this information on it. This will help you later when you are making your contacts.

**Step 3:** The final step is to review last year's Souvenir Program to see if any of the prospect's competitors have advertised, or whether they will occupy "exclusive space". Either way, it is a good selling point when you call the prospect. It is always good to show that others have advertised so he or she should too. On the other hand, being first and only in his/her category can be a strong motivator as well. Make sure you note the specifics on your note card to remind yourself when you call.

That's it.... Three easy steps to convert a suspect to a prospect! You will soon be ready for the first qualified call....I will cover what to do next in my e-mail next week.